

PETRIFIED ARMOR

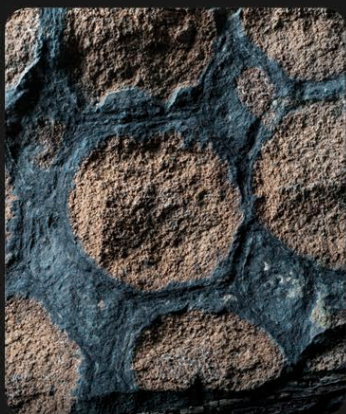
BOREALOPELTA

Hidden within a large block of stone and accidentally discovered by miners, this fossil is one of the best examples of excellently preserved dinosaur skin. The block was found in a marine deposit, which formed in a prehistoric ocean. The paleontologists from the Royal Tyrrell Museum in Canada who went to examine the fossil thought they would be looking at another of the marine reptiles that are common in those deposits. Little did they know that within the hard rock lay a large armored dinosaur, later named *Borealopelta*. It was a herbivore that belonged to a family of heavily armored ankylosaurs and may have grown up to 18 ft (5.5 m) in length. The fossil was in such a good condition that scientists have even been able to reconstruct *Borealopelta*'s reddish color.



Borealopelta's skull was heavily armored, which helped in defense against predators.

Beak



FOSSILIZED COLORS

The preserved pigments in the fossil suggest that *Borealopelta* had a rusty red back and a lightly colored belly. This camouflaged it in its plant-rich coastal habitat. At this time, predators were so deadly that even large armored dinosaurs needed to try to hide.